

Live Telecasting on Your Web



ADEEB RAZA

Presented here is an Internet-based project for telecasting live video from your computer to your webpage. The video can be viewed on the computers of your family members, relatives or friends living in different parts of the world.

This is also an interesting project for people who have basic knowledge of computer hardware, software, operating system, networking, Internet technology and webpage written in hypertext markup language (HTML). For more information, you may refer to 'Make Your Own Web Server' project published in January 2013 issue.

Tools required for the project:

1. A TV tuner card with audio and video inputs
2. A camera with audio and video outputs
3. A microphone
4. A broadband Internet modem
5. A high-speed broadband Internet connection
6. A video streaming software

Hardware and software installation

It is assumed that your PC has Windows operating system with Internet connection and is ready for the following hardware and software installations and testing:

1. Installation of a TV tuner card on the PCI slot for audio and video capturing
2. Installation of TV tuner card drivers
3. Testing of video camera picture and sound system
4. Installation of a video streaming server software
5. Creating an HTML page for live web telecasting
6. Uploading the created HTML page to your website



Fig. 1: PixelView TV tuner card with video and audio inputs

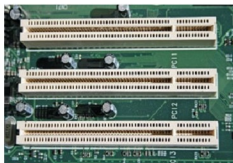


Fig. 2: PCI slots in your computer



Fig. 3: Pinnacle 110i TV tuner Card



Fig. 4: Connection of Sony Handycam with a TV tuner card

7. Watching live programme on your Web server

1. Installation of a TV tuner card for audio and video capturing. This is the most important part of the project. Here we used an inexpensive and easily available PixelView PCI TV tuner card for capturing picture and sound for telecasting.

It has video and audio input sockets provided on its back side for connecting to any type of camera with video and audio outputs.

First switch off the power supply of your PC and open the cover of the CPU unit. Insert the PixelView PCI TV tuner card (refer Fig. 1) into the spare (available) PCI slot. Use a bolt to fix the card on the frame to ensure that it is properly fixed in the PCI slot (refer Fig. 2).

Now, close the PC cover and power on your PC for TV tuner card driver installation. (Note. You can also use any other compatible TV tuner card, such as Pinnacle110i, as shown in Fig. 3. Other types of USB TV tuner cards with audio and video inputs can also be used for the purpose.)

Here we are using Sony Handycam (refer Fig. 4). A 50m long CCTV system AV cable can be used between camera and PC for longer distance coverage. (Webcam is not used due to cable length limitation and non-availability of AV outputs.)

2. Installation of TV tuner card drivers. Insert the TV tuner card driver CD in the CD drive of your PC and click on the Install option. It will start installing the driver on your PC. Follow the on-screen instructions as shown in Fig. 5.

If you are using Pinnacle 110i TV tuner, you can download the driver from the link mentioned below:

<http://drivers.softpedia.com/dynpostdownload.php?p=14328&t=4&i=1>

3. Testing of video camera picture and sound system. After driver in-